

EST. 2007



**WESTERN CANADIAN
SHORT LINE RAILWAY**



ASSOC.

PRAIRIE CONNECT Concept



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Intro

The Western Canada Short Line Railway Association (WCSLRA) represents 20+ short line railways across British Columbia, Alberta, Saskatchewan, and Manitoba, along with key supplier partners across the rail sector.

We advocate for safe, sustainable, and efficient freight and passenger rail, strengthen economic opportunities for rural communities, and support the modernization and long-term competitiveness of rail transportation in Western Canada.

WCSLRA members form essential links in Canada's supply chain connecting rural producers and industries to national rail networks, trade corridors, and global markets.

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Our Board & Staff

The **WCSLRA** is guided by experienced operators, policy specialists, and community-focused leaders from across Western Canada. Their combined expertise in rail operations, regulatory affairs, economics, and government relations ensures strong governance and effective delivery of sector-wide initiatives.

www.wcslra.com

WCSLRA Board of Directors & Staff

Board of Directors :

Andrew Glastetter, President

Andrew Glastetter is the General Manager of the Great Western Railway group of companies including Great Western Railway of Saskatchewan, The Fife Lake Railway, and Great Western Commodities. Great Western Railway is Saskatchewan's largest short line railway operating 440 miles of track in south central and south western Saskatchewan and has been in operation since September 2000.

Andrew's over 35 years in leadership and team development has involved both short line rail, and class 1 operations throughout Western Canada and the United States.

In addition to the WCSLRA, Andrew serves on the board of directors of the Western Transportation Advisory Council (WESTAC) and chairs the Short Line Committee meetings at the Railway Association of Canada. Prior to joining the Great Western Railway in 2015, Andrew was the Regional Vice President of Canadian Rail Operations for Omnitrac, and held various operations management positions with both CN, and BC Rail.

Matt Enright, Vice President

Matt Enright is the General Manager of Battle River Railway NGC and Battle River Grain in Forestburg, Alberta. He holds a Masters in Economics from Simon Fraser University and is the driving force behind the Battle River Grain expansion and other business diversification goals at Battle River Railway. Matt farms grain near Rosalind, AB and is an active community volunteer in his local region.

Aaron Wenzel, Director of Regulatory Affairs

Mr. Wenzel has over 17 years of rail experience, 12 of which have been in management in the short-line railway industry. Mr. Wenzel has overseen all aspects of shortline railway operations and regulatory affairs at both the Provincial and Federal levels for 9961526 Canada Limited and Great Sandhills Railway Ltd. Mr. Wenzel is currently the General Manager of Great Sandhills Railway, managing 40 Employees in 4 departments and also serves as the Director of Regulatory Affairs at the WCSLRA and sits on Transport Canada's Advisory Council on Rail Safety. In Dec 2020, Mr. Wenzel entered into municipal politics and was elected Mayor of the Town of Leader.

WCSLRA Staff :**Rachel Mackenzie, Director of Communications and Government Relations**

Rachel Mackenzie has served as the Director of Communications and Government Relations for the Western Canadian Short Line Railway Association since 2021 where she leads federal, provincial, and municipal advocacy on behalf of the short line industry. Rachel serves on a variety of rail industry working groups and is a regular contributor to stakeholder engagement and community education initiatives.

Rachel has a BSc. from the University of Victoria with a professional background that includes academic research, radio journalism and documentary making.

She has previously managed projects funded by federal grants, including a successful multi-year project with PrairiesCan.

Karen Philipation, Administration

Karen has served as bookkeeper for the WCSLRA for 7 years with a professional background in marketing and business administration.

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Hitting Up Studios

Hitting Up Studios is a multi-disciplinary creative and technology studio. We design and build experiences that sit at the intersection of art, sound, storytelling, and modern web development. Our work spans brands, mapping platforms, digital tools, and community-focused communications.

Over the past several years, we've collaborated closely with the WCSLRA on projects funded by PrairiesCan, including brand and web development, photography, business and marketing strategies for the Association and its member railways, Build Here site promotion, and sector-wide communication tools. This work has given us deep insight into short line operations, rural development opportunities, and the digital needs of the rail sector.

Co-Founders & Studio Leads :

Nolan Demich, Creative Director & Project Manager

Nolan is a creative director and designer with more than 35 years of experience in branding, visual communication, and strategic design. His work blends clarity, storytelling, and practical insight to help organizations communicate complex ideas in simple, compelling ways.

He has a knack for turning broad concepts into organized, approachable systems and guiding both creative and technical teams toward consistent, usable results. His approach emphasizes clarity, usability, and thoughtful communication in every stage of a project.

Originally from a family rooted in southern Saskatchewan, Nolan spent his childhood summers working on his grandparents' ranch, where he witnessed firsthand the economic and community impacts of rural rail line removals. This lived experience informs his work today, giving him a grounded appreciation for the role short lines play in rural resilience, trade access, and local opportunity.

Chris Martin, Chief Technical Officer

Chris is a seasoned software engineer and technical strategist with over 25 years of experience building digital platforms, complex systems, and user-friendly tools. His expertise spans full-stack development, API design, data architecture, and modern web frameworks, with a strong focus on reliability, usability, and long-term maintainability.

Chris has led development on numerous large-scale web and mapping platforms, bringing a mix of technical depth, systems thinking, and calm, efficient execution. He excels at translating complex requirements into simple, intuitive solutions and is the backbone behind Hitting Up's technical delivery for WCSLRA's websites and digital tools.

He is known for being a collaborative communicator, a thoughtful problem-solver, and a developer who consistently delivers clean, scalable, future-proof systems.

Hitting Up Staff :

Brett Studer, Designer & Digital Media Specialist

Brett is a multidisciplinary designer with over 15 years of experience in graphic design, web development, photography, and interactive media. He brings a strong blend of creative strategy and technical execution, helping transform concepts into clear, engaging visual experiences. Brett's work spans brand development, UI design, digital storytelling, and multimedia production.

Lana Winnichyn, Programmer & UX Designer

Lana is a programmer and designer with 15 years of experience in web development, UI/UX design, and digital content creation. Her strength lies in building clean, intuitive interfaces and translating design concepts into functional, user-friendly web experiences. Lana brings a thoughtful, detail-oriented approach to every project.





**Prairie
Connect**

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Prairie Connect / Concept Overview

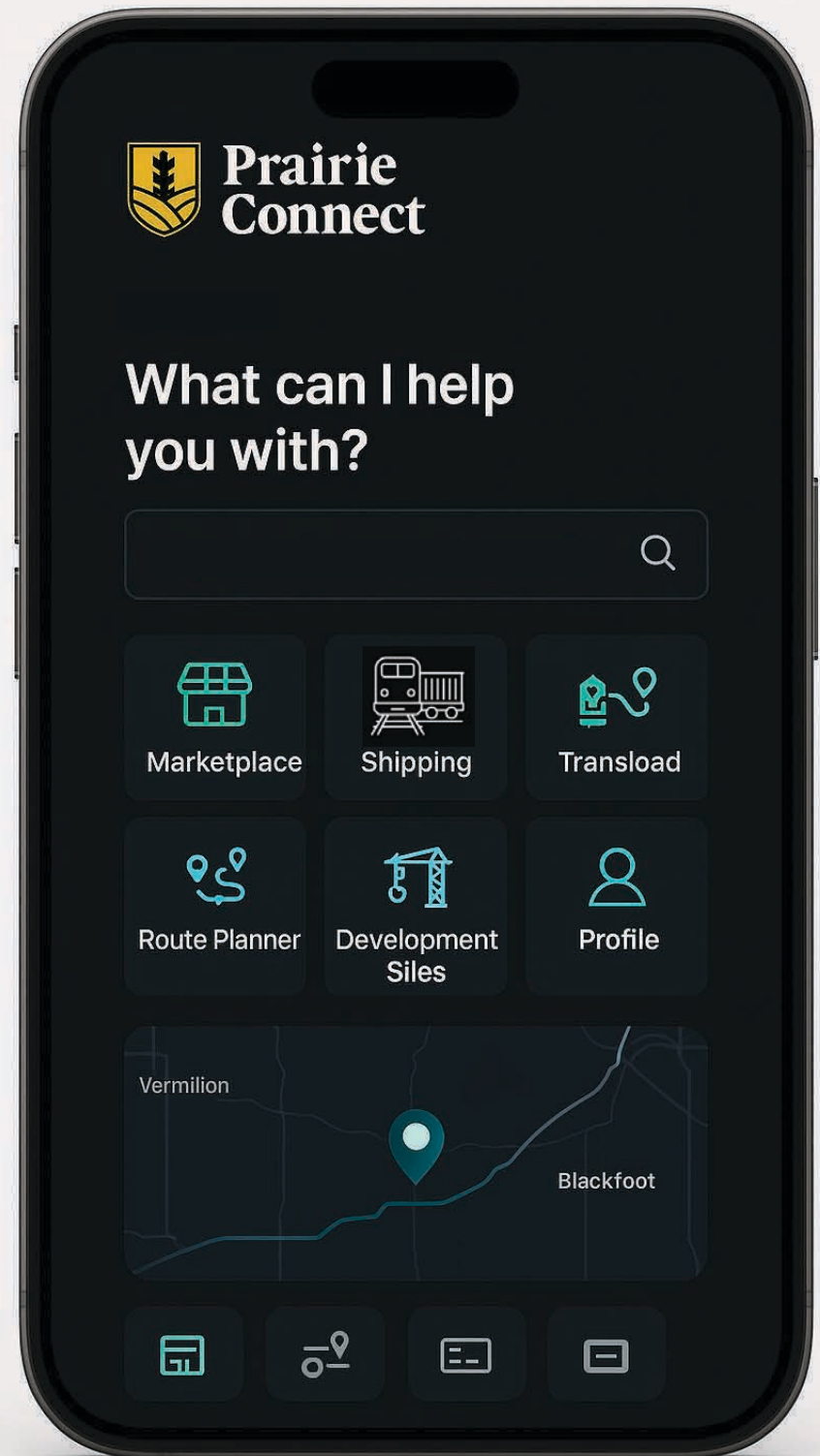
Prairie Connect is a map-based platform that brings producers, shippers, short line railways, and economic development partners into one place. It helps users find nearby rail options, compare routes, and connect with the right partners to move goods more efficiently across the Prairies.

Short lines are expanding beyond bulk grain and storage traffic, and Prairie Connect supports this shift by highlighting market opportunities, showcasing rail-served sites, and turning rural corridors into visible, data-driven trade networks.

Through simple tools like Universal Search, Find-My-Route, and curated Marketplace and Matchmaking directories, Prairie Connect makes rail shipping more accessible, strengthens regional coordination, and opens new domestic and export markets for Prairie businesses.

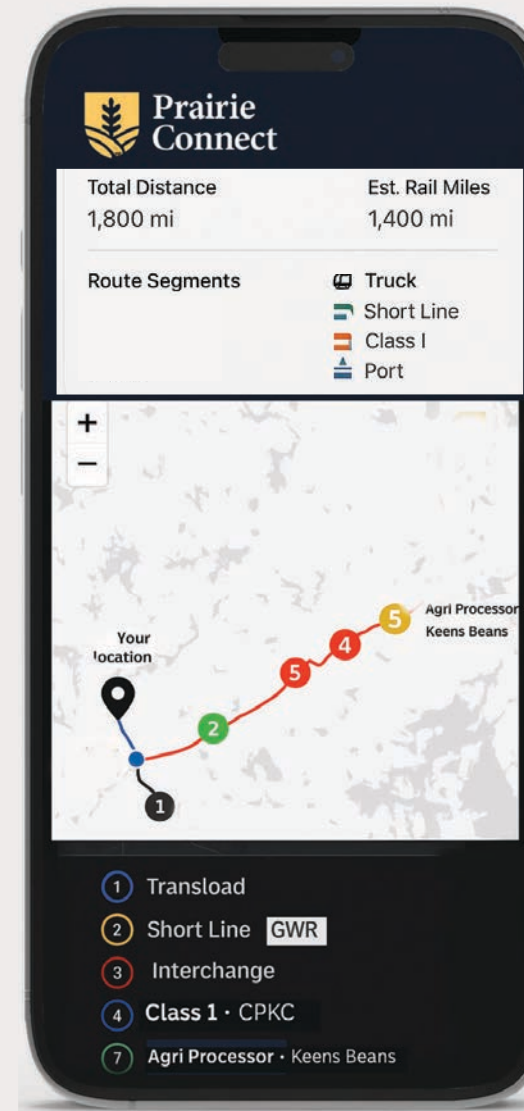
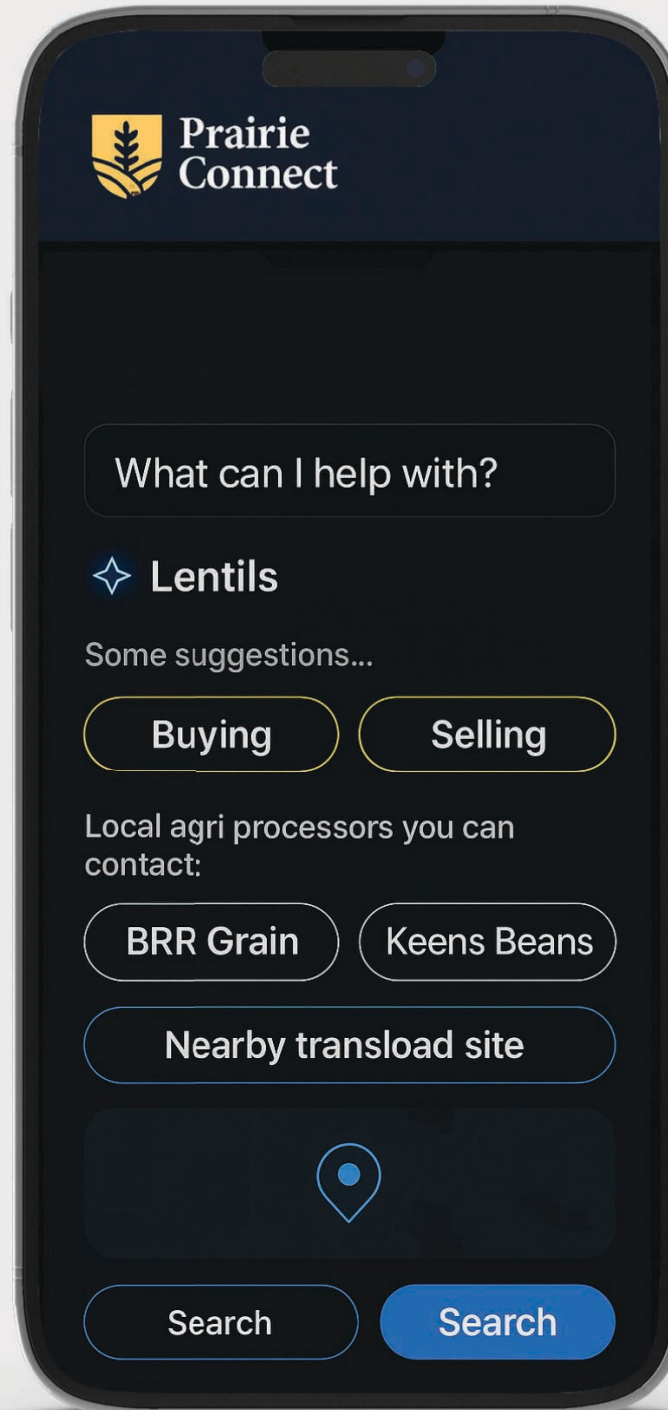
Home Screen

The Home Screen is the user's entry point into Prairie Connect. It provides quick access to core tools through simple icon-based navigation, guided search, and AI-assisted suggestions. This screen is designed to help users immediately find what they need whether that's shipping options, development sites, or route planning based on their location and intent.



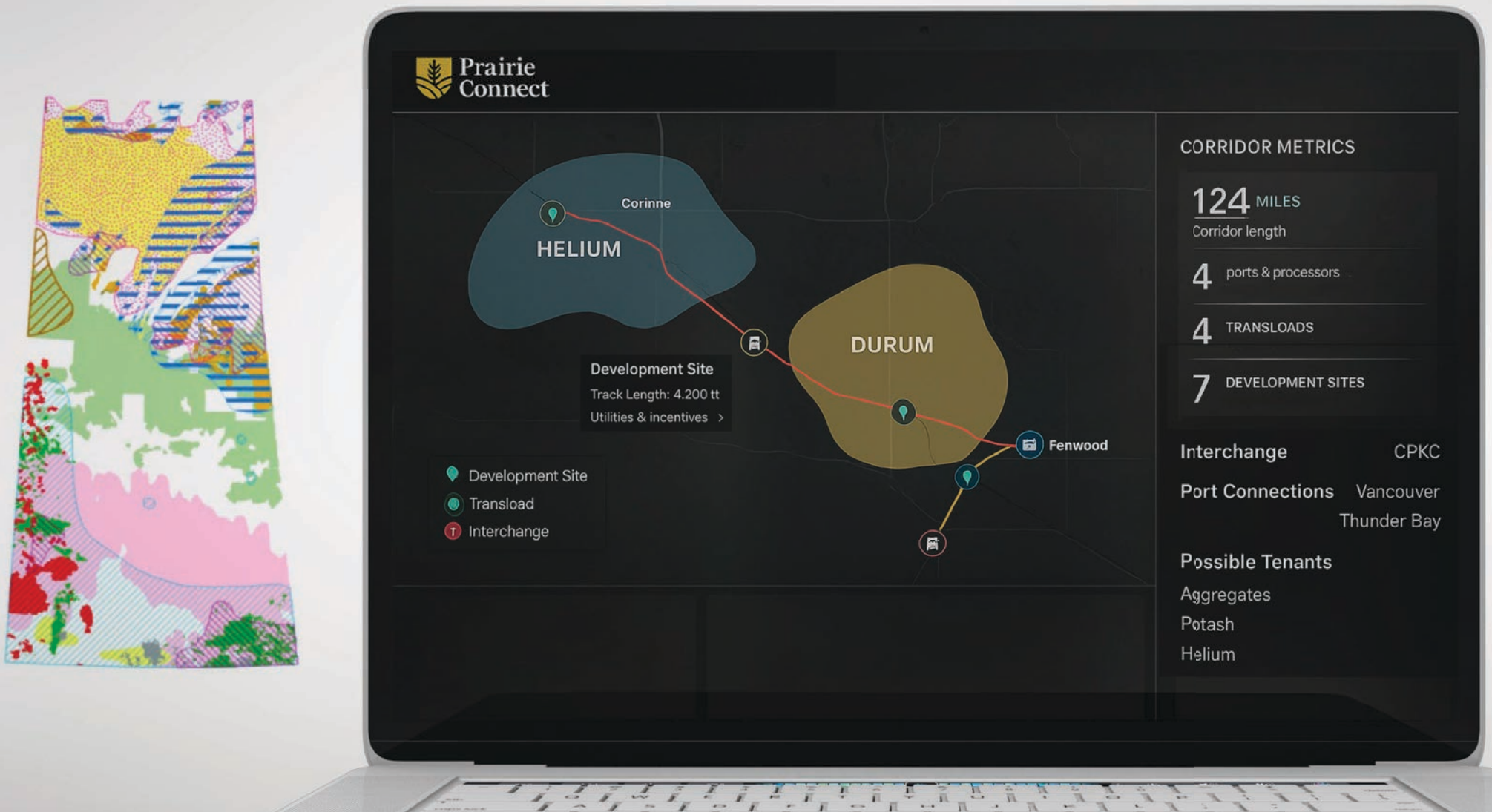
Ai Assisted Search / Match

This screen demonstrates how Prairie Connect guides users from a simple search to a clear set of options and connections. The platform suggests buyers, processors, transload sites, and nearby rail access points based on the user's query. It also provides an immediate route overview showing how a shipment can move across short line, Class I, truck, and port segments. The goal is to help users quickly identify partners, understand their logistics options, and map a complete path from origin to destination.



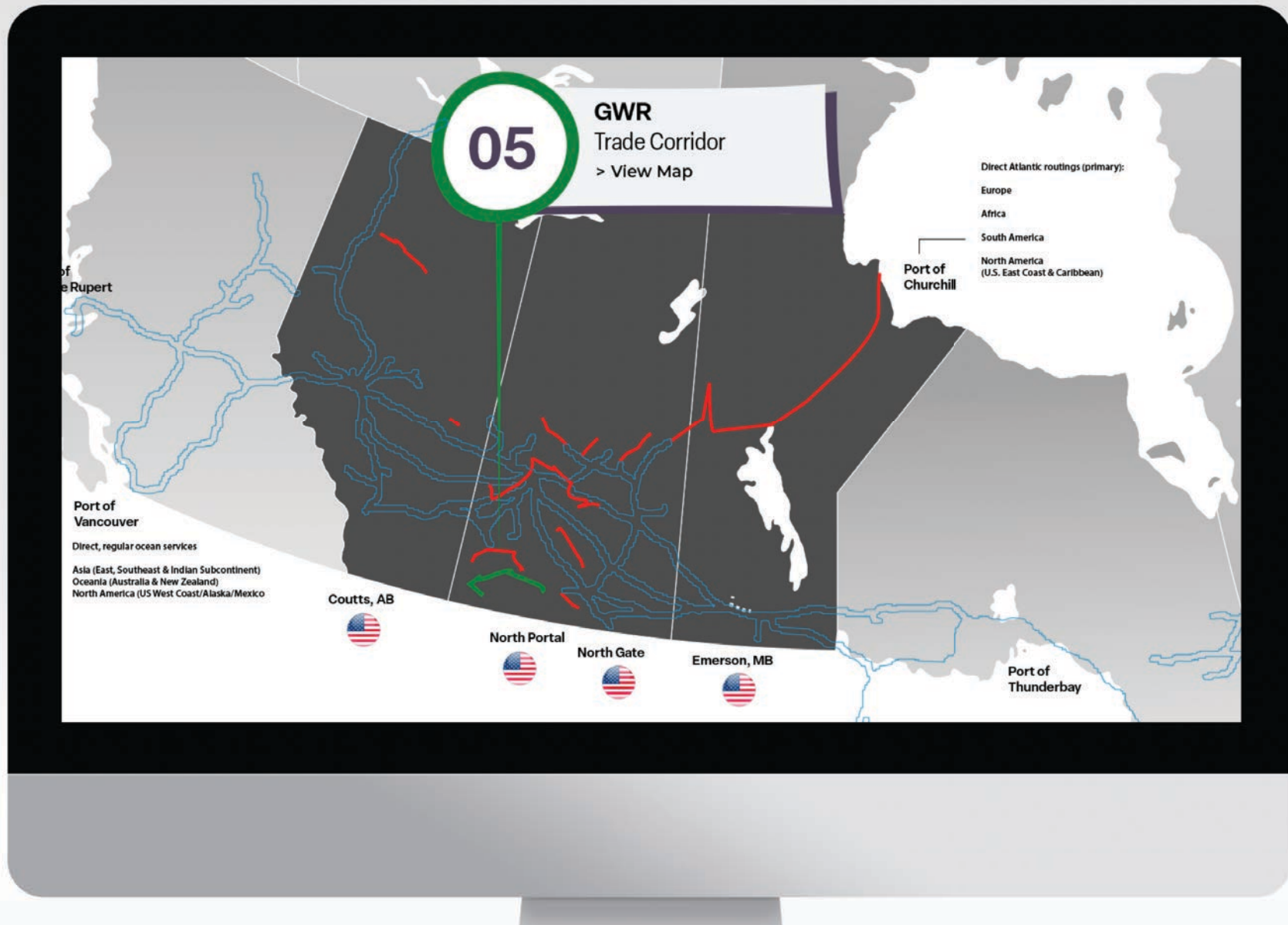
Digital Trade Corridors

This view illustrates how Prairie Connect turns individual sites and assets into a clear, connected trade corridor. Users can explore rail served routes, development clusters, facilities, interchanges, and regional resources through an interactive map that highlights how goods move in and out of a region. The tool helps short lines and communities showcase their corridors, understand opportunities, and identify where new tenants or industries could fit within the existing network.



High Level Trade Corridor map

This screen presents a top level view of all Prairie trade corridors with short line operated routes highlighted. Users can select any corridor to explore its rail served path, key industrial connections, and links to major ports and border crossings. The map provides an immediate understanding of how regional short lines tie into the wider national rail network and global export routes.



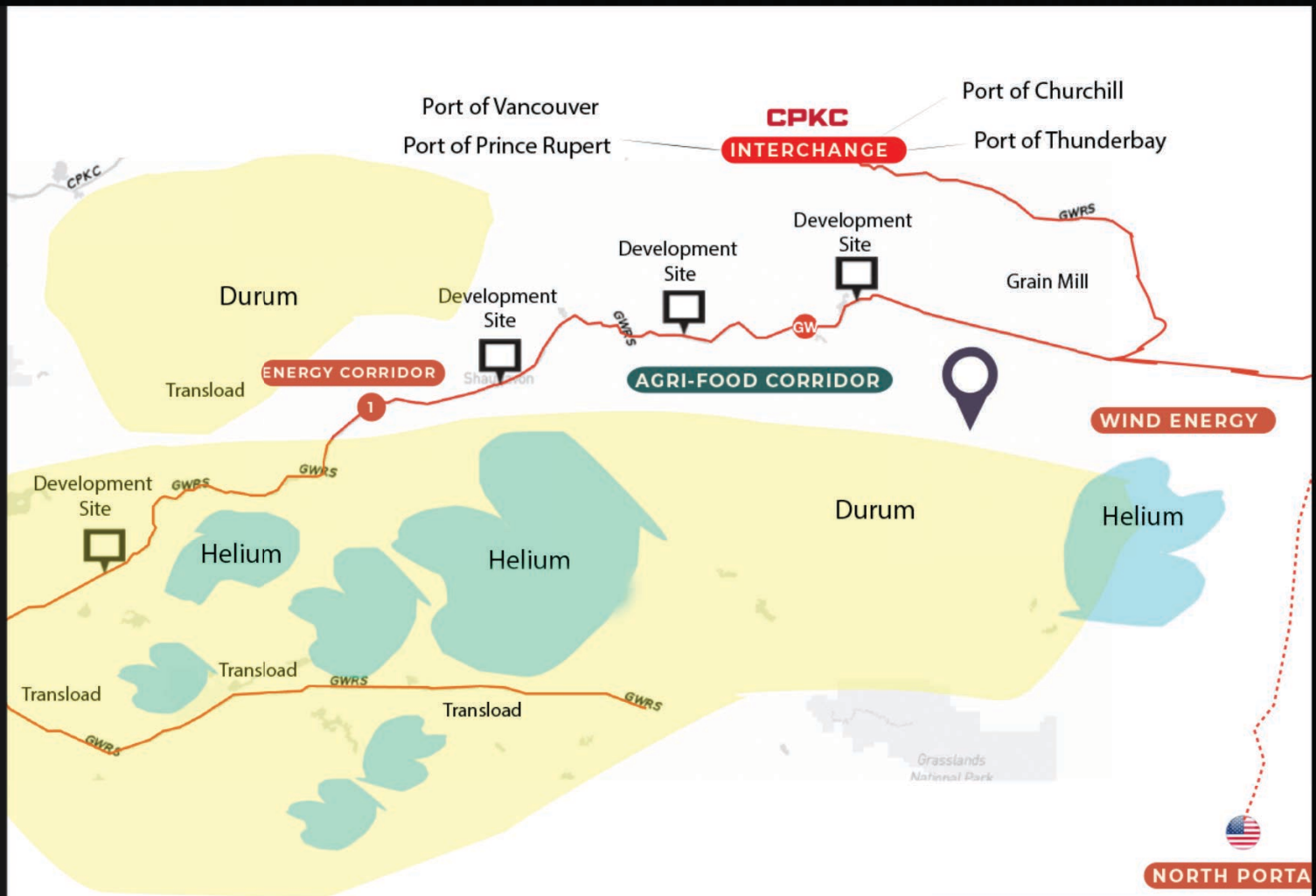
GWR Trade Corridor

- Show Resources
- Development Sites (11)
- Transload Sites (23)
- Development Sites (9)
- Communities (35)
- Agri Processors (3)
- Development zones (9)

Corridor Metrics

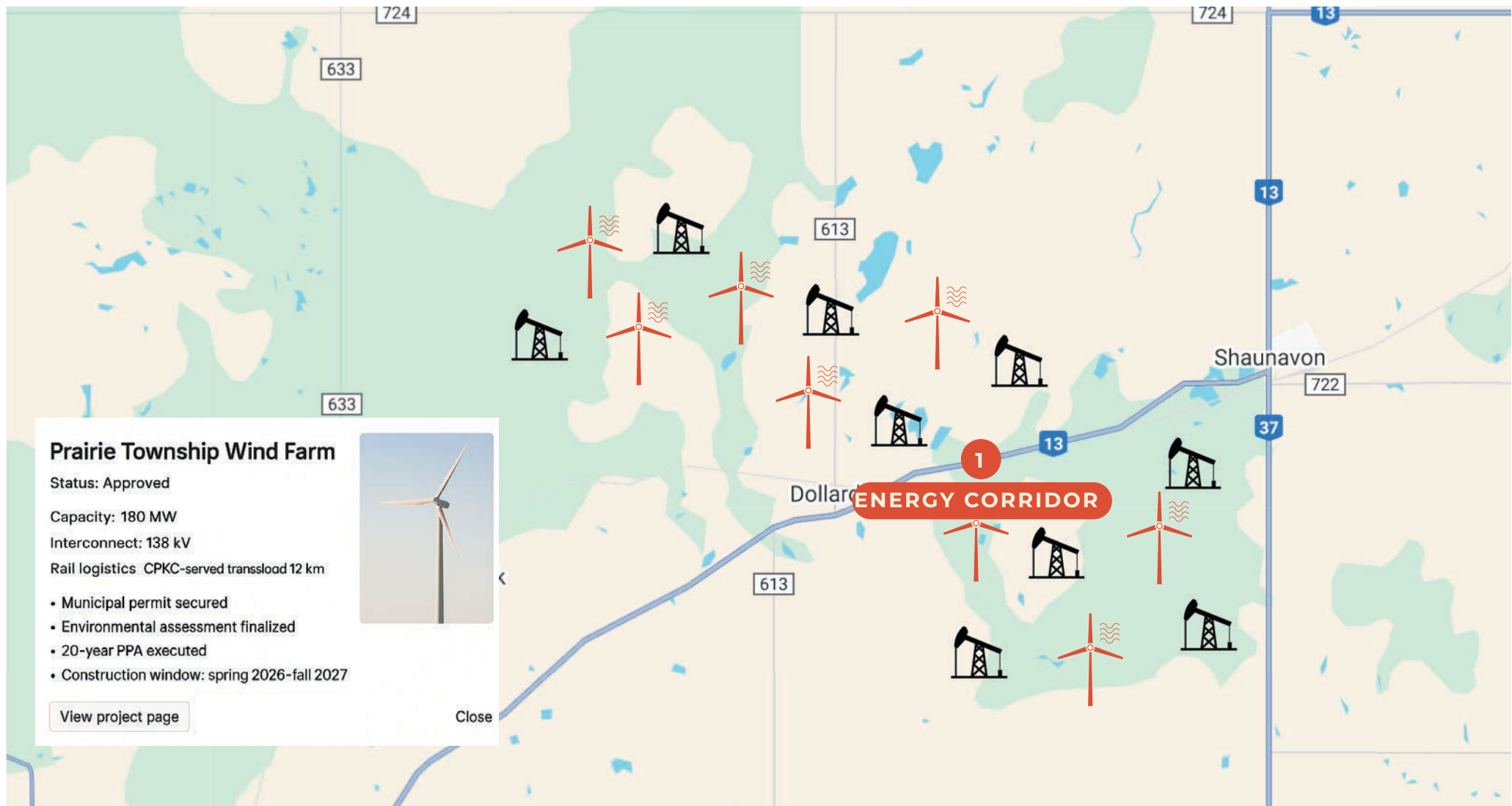
Track length	115mi
Interchange	CPKC
Port connections	- Vancouver - Churchill - Thunder Bay
Possible tenants	- Aggregates - Potash - Helium

Route Planner



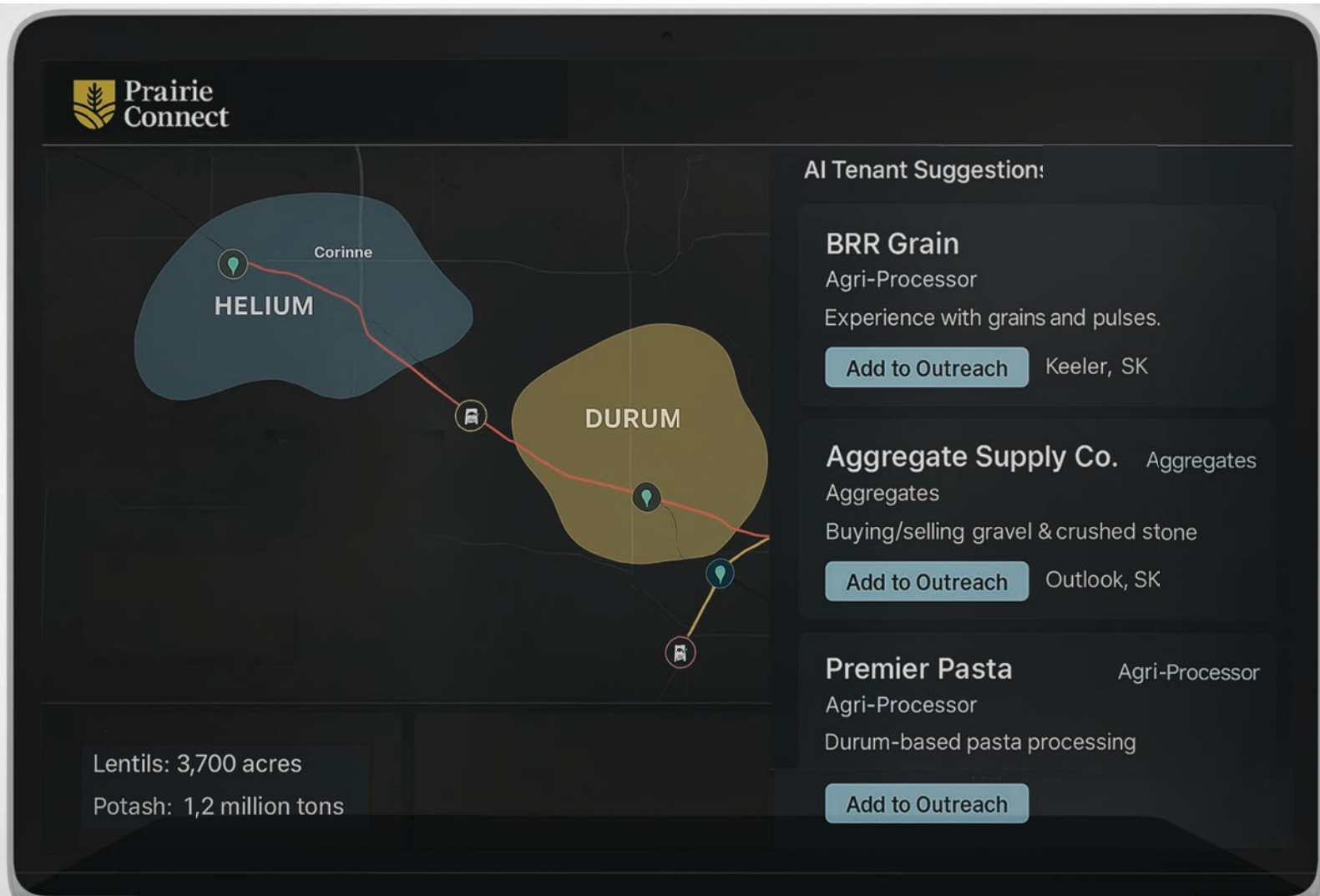
Corridor Zoom and Development Opportunities

This view highlights how Prairie Connect can showcase local development zones within a trade corridor, such as energy projects, agri-processing clusters, and other municipal or RM approved sites. By visualizing nearby projects, resources, and investment activity, the platform helps short lines and communities market their regions, attract sector partners, and support cluster-driven economic growth.



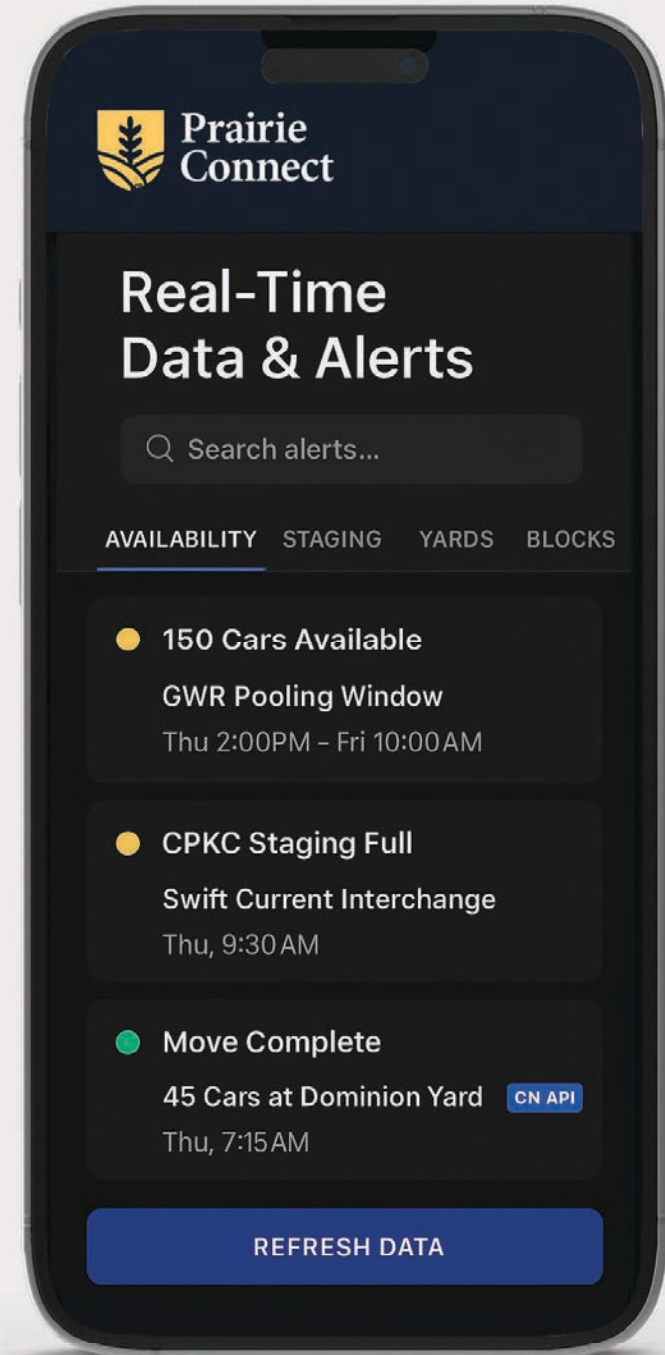
AI Assisted Development Directory

This screen shows how Prairie Connect can use AI to help short lines identify potential tenants and sector partners based on the resources and opportunities within a corridor. The platform suggests relevant companies, highlights why they are a good fit, and generates simple outreach packs that support corridor marketing and business development.



API Plugins and Real Time Data

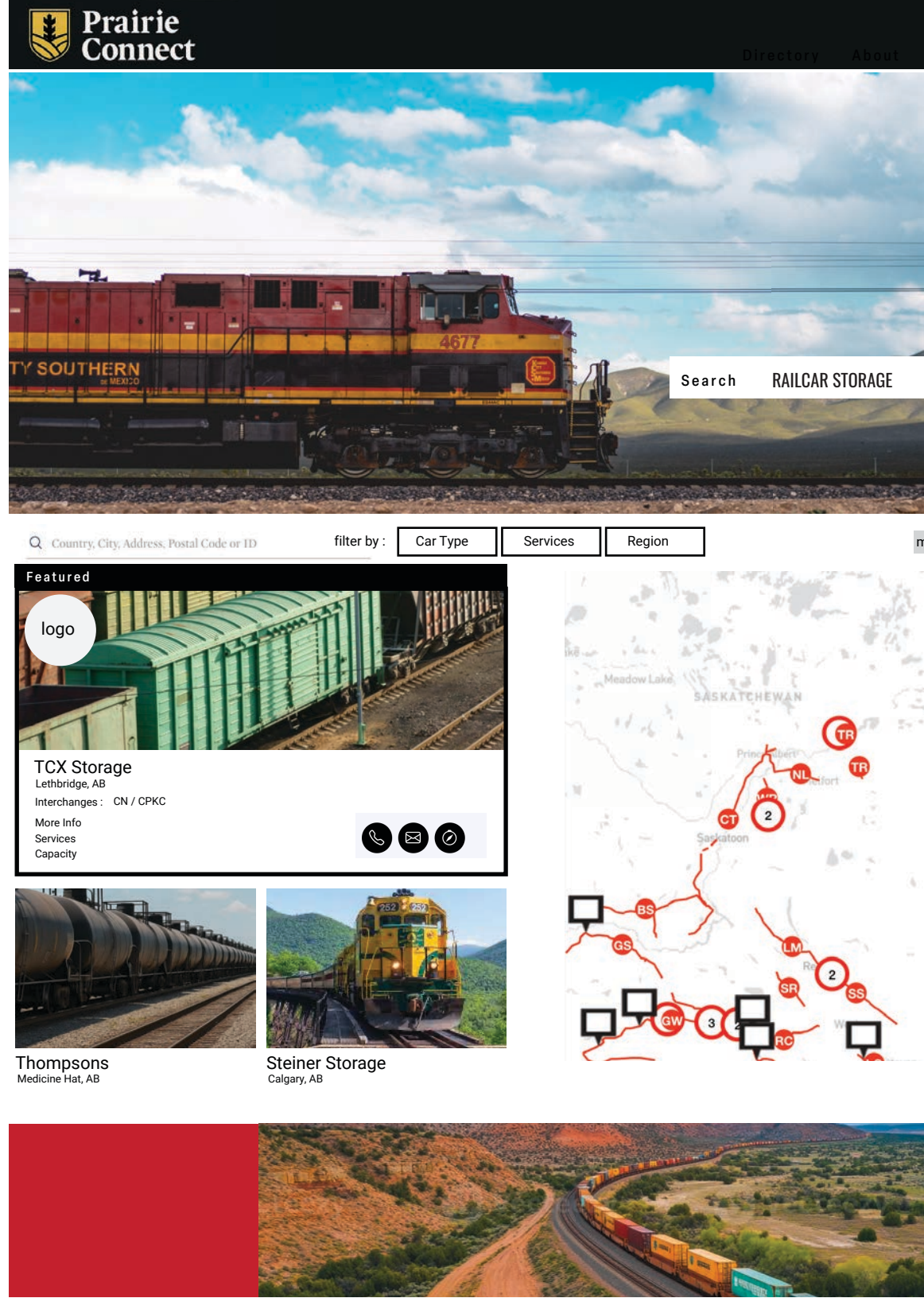
This screen shows how Prairie Connect can integrate available API feeds from Class I railways and other partners to display real time information such as car availability, staging updates, interchange status, and shipment milestones. These data connections help users stay informed, plan with greater accuracy, and make rail shipping more predictable and reliable.



Evergreen Sustainability & Premium Listings

This view demonstrates how Prairie Connect can generate ongoing revenue through optional premium listings within its directories. When users search for services such as transloading or storage in a specific region, verified companies can choose to appear at the top of the results. These listings are location aware, relevant to user intent, and displayed in a way that maintains the integrity and usability of the platform.

Alongside this feature, Prairie Connect is designed to support ongoing development through subscription tools, data services, and corridor sponsorships. The model can scale naturally with platform traffic and usage, allowing the system to grow and evolve as adoption increases.



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Thank you for your time